

# Comms Academy

Redesigning the AI-Powered Communications Platform for Amazon Customer Service

A UX Case Study by Pradeep | UX Designer & Developer

*[VISUAL: Hero Banner — Full-width hero showcasing the redesigned Comms Academy platform UI with AI Tools section visible. Dark or branded background with project title, role, and key stat overlay ("100% TM Engagement").]*

## Introduction

### Overview of the Project

Comms Academy is a centralized, AI-powered communication toolkit built for L4+ Team Managers and Individual Contributors in Amazon Customer Service. It serves as a one-stop hub providing standardized templates and frameworks, real-time AI writing assistance, channel guidance, playbooks, workshops, and on-demand learning modules — replacing a fragmented, underperforming platform with an intuitive, self-service communication ecosystem. The project involved a complete UX redesign and full development of an existing but neglected wiki-based platform, transforming it from a low-engagement static resource into a dynamic, AI-powered toolkit.

### Project Name & Client

**Project:** Comms Academy

**Organization:** Amazon Customer Service — Communications & Leadership Development (CLD)

### Role & Responsibilities

I served as the UX Designer & Developer responsible for the platform's complete redesign and development. My role encompassed user research (interviews with 40 stakeholders across 3 leadership levels), information architecture redesign, UI design, prototyping, A/B testing with 120+ participants, and full platform development and deployment. This dual design-engineering role enabled rapid iteration without handoff delays.

*[VISUAL: Project Snapshot Card — Summary card: Role: UX Designer & Developer | Duration: 3 months | Tools: Figma, Wiki Platform | Methods: User Interviews (40 participants), A/B Testing (120+) | Impact: 100% TM engagement | 79.31% AI tool adoption | 8/10 satisfaction]*

# Problem Statement

## What Problem Are We Solving?

Before the redesign, the Comms Academy platform had an outdated design with no repeat users and falling adoption. Users came to the platform but couldn't find what they needed. Meanwhile, communication quality varied wildly across CS sites — Connections satisfaction scores ranged from 32% to 86% — and L4+ managers spent excessive time creating communications from scratch with no standardized templates for critical scenarios (virtual leadership, coaching, performance discussions, change management).

*[VISUAL: Problem Ecosystem Diagram — Illustration showing the problem state: Old Wiki Platform (outdated design), Scattered AI Tools, No Templates, Write-from-Scratch Workflow, Inconsistent Quality. Center label: "Falling Adoption & No Repeat Users"]*

## Business & User Challenges

### Business Challenges:

- Inconsistent communication quality across CS sites (Connections scores: 32-86% variation)
- L4+ managers spending excessive time creating communications from scratch
- Lack of standardized templates for critical scenarios
- AI tools scattered across multiple locations with no centralized access
- Existing platform had no repeat users — adoption was falling

### User Challenges:

- Platform design was outdated with poor discoverability
- No AI-powered assistance for daily communication tasks
- No standardized localized frameworks (especially critical for non-English markets)
- Virtual engagement extremely difficult with tenured teams
- Communication guidelines hard to remember and apply in daily work
- Engagement deprioritized during huddles in favor of operational updates

## Goals & Objectives

*[VISUAL: Project Goals — Numbered Badges: 1. Redesign platform UX, 2. Centralize AI tools, 3. Enable self-service, 4. Increase adoption & repeat usage, 5. Standardize communication quality, 6. Support regional localization]*

1. Redesign the platform into an intuitive, modern communication ecosystem
2. Centralize scattered AI-powered writing tools in one accessible location
3. Enable self-service communication creation without writing from scratch
4. Increase platform adoption and create repeat usage patterns
5. Standardize communication quality across all CS sites
6. Support regional localization with culturally-adapted frameworks

## Research & Discovery

### User Research

*[VISUAL: Research Scale Infographic — Large-number callouts: 40 stakeholders interviewed | 8 L7-L8 leaders + 13 Ops Managers + 19 Team Managers | 120+ A/B test participants | 3 user segments]*

I conducted 40 interviews across the leadership chain: 8 L7-L8 senior leaders, 13 Operations Managers, and approximately 19 Team Managers. This multi-level approach was intentional — communication challenges manifested differently at each level, and we needed to understand the full picture from strategic direction to daily execution. An A/B test was distributed to 120+ team members to validate design decisions at scale.

The Italy pilot served as the primary research ground, with focus groups revealing daily communication challenges faced by L4-L6 managers. Interviews revealed critical insights:

- Managers struggled with virtual engagement for tenured teams with limited turnover
- Communication guidelines were hard to remember and apply in daily work
- No standardized localized frameworks existed for non-English markets
- AI tools existed but were scattered — users wanted them in one place
- Users needed active tools that help them write, not just static best practices to read

### Key Testimonials from ITA Team Managers:

*“The priority in recent years, especially in this period of change, is to keep associate motivation high, to lighten the burden of associates. Considering the limited turnover and permanence in the same role for most associates, there is little freshness and it is difficult to create a fertile ground for engagement.”*

*“We need intuitive training, which supports us in daily work to remember what we can say and what not, based on Amazon communication guidelines, to reach effective and empathic communication.”*

*“The hardest challenge is to effectively and properly communicate with our directs, without being misunderstood. A standardized communication in Italian language is required, which takes into account all the specifics of the Italian market.”*

*“Engagement often takes a back seat in favor of urgent communication and/or operational updates during the huddles. It's very difficult to create engagement in a virtual environment for lack of time and/or people.”*

## Key Insights & Findings

*[VISUAL: Insight Cards — 5 Key Findings with severity indicators]*

7. Users needed active AI tools that help them write — not just static resources to read
8. Virtual engagement with tenured teams was the #1 pain point for managers
9. Communication guidelines compliance required in-the-moment support, not periodic training
10. Localization was critical — generic English frameworks didn't serve non-English markets
11. Platform adoption required AI tools front-and-center (driven by user demand + org AI push)

## User Personas & Empathy Mapping

### Target Users & Their Needs

*[VISUAL: Persona Cards — Three Personas side-by-side]*

#### Primary Persona: The Team Manager (L4-L6)

- Manages a specific CS team
- Needs quick, standardized communication tools for daily use
- Struggles with virtual engagement for tenured associates
- Wants self-service without dependency on comms or design teams
- Values guideline compliance and consistent messaging

#### Secondary Persona: The Operations Manager

- Oversees multiple TMs and needs cross-team communication standards
- Values scalable frameworks that ensure quality across all direct reports
- Needs visibility into adoption and usage

### Tertiary Persona: The Senior Leader (L7-L8)

- Drives strategic communication direction
- Needs assurance that platform delivers measurable improvement
- Sponsors change management communications

## Empathy Maps

*[VISUAL: Empathy Map — Quadrant Layout (Says, Thinks, Does, Feels)]*

**Says:** "We need intuitive training" / "It's difficult to create engagement in a virtual environment"

**Thinks:** "There must be a better way" / "Am I communicating this correctly?"

**Does:** Writes communications from scratch / Asks colleagues for examples / Deprioritizes engagement for ops

**Feels:** Frustrated / Time-pressured / Uncertain about guidelines

## User Journey & Experience Mapping

### Current vs. Ideal User Journey

*[VISUAL: Journey Map — Before vs. After comparison]*

#### Before Journey (5+ steps, 30-60 min):

Need communication → Search through wiki pages → Can't find relevant template → Write from scratch → Self-doubt about guidelines → Send with uncertainty

Emotion: Neutral → Frustrated → Uncertain. Time: 30-60 minutes.

#### After Journey (3 steps, under 5 min):

Need communication → Open Comms Academy → Select AI tool or template → Generate and customize → Send with confidence

Emotion: Neutral → Satisfied → Confident. Time: Under 5 minutes.

## Information Architecture & Wireframing

## Information Architecture

The IA redesign centered on one critical insight: users needed AI tools front-and-center because that's what they were explicitly asking for. The existing platform buried useful content under promotional clutter and decorative elements. The new IA was built on a tools-first hierarchy:

Comms Academy Home → AI Tools (top, tabbed: Team Engagement | Team Communication | Change Communications) → Channel Guide (Digital / In-Person) → Playbooks → Workshops → On-Demand Learning

This structure was validated by A/B testing with 120+ participants: AI-tools-first layout was overwhelmingly preferred over content-first alternatives.

## Low-Fidelity Wireframes

*[VISUAL: Low-Fidelity Wireframes — Key Pages: 1. Home/AI Tools section, 2. Channel Guide, 3. Playbooks, 4. On-Demand Learning]*

Wireframes focused on three critical design decisions:

12. AI Tools Section — Positioned at the top with tabbed category filters (Team Engagement, Team Communication, Change Communications). Each tool displayed as a card with title and description.
13. Channel Guide — Tabbed interface (Digital Channels / In-Person Channels) with detailed guidance cards replacing the previous link-dump format.
14. On-Demand Learning — Entirely new section providing self-paced modules with clear descriptions and learning outcomes.

## Design Iterations

*[VISUAL: A/B Testing Variations — Side-by-side comparisons showing tested alternatives]*

Multiple iterations were required. Key A/B test results:

- AI-tools-first layout overwhelmingly preferred over content-first
- Category tabs reduced cognitive load vs. flat card list
- Users wanted tool descriptions visible without clicking into detail
- Card-based playbooks preferred over decorative circular icons

## UI Design & Prototyping

## Visual Design Decisions

The redesign prioritized clarity over decoration. Key visual decisions:

- Removed promotional banner clutter that dominated the old viewport
- Introduced card-based AI tool display with clear descriptions
- Replaced decorative circular playbook icons with descriptive labeled cards
- Added On-Demand Learning section (completely new)
- Implemented tabbed navigation for category filtering (Team Engagement, Team Communication, Change Communications)

## Before & After

*[VISUAL: Before screenshot — Old Comms Academy: promotional banner, circular playbook icons, no AI tools, Resources link list at bottom]*

*[VISUAL: After screenshot — New Comms Academy: AI Tools section with tabbed filters, card-based tools with descriptions, On-Demand Learning section]*

Key changes: AI Tools front-and-center (user-driven decision), tabbed category filters, descriptive cards replacing decorative icons, new On-Demand Learning section.

## Results & Impact

### Pilot Results

The Italy pilot (Aug-Sept 2025) served as the validation phase before global rollout:

**100%** CS ITA Team Manager engagement within 6 weeks

**79.31%** adoption rate of Email Assistant tool

**8/10** user satisfaction and recommendation score

**128** total AI tool interactions within first 6 weeks

**75.86%** Office Hours attendance (22 out of 29 CS ITA TMs)

**70%** comms best practice adherence target — on track

## Stakeholder Testimonials

**ITA Site Lead:**

*“The Comms Hub has delivered tangible benefits for our team communications. The Email Assistant helps our managers save significant time in crafting clear, professional messages, while the Change Management Tool Kit provides practical frameworks. Having these resources centralized in one platform has improved both the efficiency and quality of our team communications.”*

#### **ITA Ops Manager:**

*“I'd like to recognize the outstanding launch of the Communications Hub platform! An innovative solution that centralizes communication resources, provides AI-powered assistants, and offers ready-to-use templates for our Team Managers. This initiative will significantly improve TMs operational efficiency and communication consistency!”*

#### **ITA Team Manager:**

*“What immediately stands out is its extraordinary ease of use: the intuitive interface allows you to generate professional content in just a few steps, without the need for specific technical skills. Artificial intelligence perfectly understands communication needs and generates relevant, well-structured texts. The Comms Hub represents a real step forward in improving the efficiency of corporate communication.”*

## **Accessibility Considerations**

15. Consistent heading hierarchy with clear section labels (AI Tools, Channel Guide, Playbooks, Workshops, On-Demand Learning) — no reliance on icons alone.
16. Keyboard-navigable tabs — category filters and channel guide tabs fully accessible with visible focus states.
17. Descriptive tool cards — every AI tool includes a clear text description of its purpose, not just a title.

## **Takeaways & Next Steps**

### **What I Learned**

- AI tools need to be where users already go — centralizing scattered tools in the platform users were already visiting drove immediate adoption.
- User-driven IA is critical — putting AI tools first because TMs explicitly asked for it validated the research-driven approach over assumptions.
- Dual designer-developer role enabled rapid iteration — no handoff delays between design decisions and implementation meant faster feedback loops.
- Iterative A/B testing with 120+ participants prevented costly late-stage mistakes and built organizational confidence in design decisions.



## **Next Steps**

18. Expand AI tool library — add tools for coaching conversations, performance discussions, and change communications based on usage data.
19. Regional localization — scale the Italy pilot approach to additional markets with culturally-adapted frameworks and language support.
20. Personalized experience — implement recommendations based on team role, tenure, and past usage patterns for each manager.